



CSIS2624

Human Computer Interaction

NQF 6

14 Credits

Computer Science and
Informatics

Compiled by

Dr Benjamin Botha

Faculty of
**Natural and Agricultural
Sciences**

www.ufs.ac.za/cs

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1. WELCOMING

Dear student,

Welcome to CSIS2624, Human-Computer Interaction! I am Dr Bennie Botha, and I have the privilege to teach this module. In this document you will find all the relevant information that you will need for this module, as well as how to contact me and other relevant staff members in the Department of Computer Science & Informatics.

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Module Objective

The aim of CSIS2624 is to introduce you to the fundamental and exciting discipline of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI). This will assist you to understand the designs that people need, to distinguish between good and bad user interfaces, to take note of your options in terms of interaction types, to be exposed to a vast number of different and exciting interface types, to know and apply the different screen design patterns, and to learn the basics of usability testing.



Module Outcomes

3. MODULE OUTCOMES

After successful completion of this module, you should be able to:

- Display knowledge of the basic principles of Interaction Design.
- Identify usability goals and user experience goals for proposed interactive systems.
- Redesign poorly designed user interfaces.
- Distinguish between and select appropriate interface types.
- Determine user needs and convert them into requirements in order to ensure that the interactive product helps the user to perform his/her task in an effective, efficient, and enjoyable manner.
- Display and apply knowledge on the evaluation of a user interface (interactive product) in terms of usability.



Learning Units

In addressing the module outcomes above, the learning units in this module will be presented per week.

Please refer to the Module Calendar in Section 8 below, as well as to the CSIS2624 Blackboard page. Also bear in mind that this is a *dynamic* schedule. Changes and updates to this calendar will be communicated to you during contact sessions and via Blackboard.



Pre-Requisites

5. PREREQUISITES

You must have successfully completed CSIS1614 or CSIS1534 before you can register for CSIS2624. Please consult the faculty yearbook for more information.



Credits and Notational Learning Hours

'Notional learning hours' indicate the amount of learning time taken by the 'average' student to achieve the specified learning outcomes of the course unit or programme. This includes all learning relevant to achieving the learning outcomes, e.g., directed study, essential practical work, group work, private study, preparation, and assessment.

This module has 16 credits, requiring 160 notional learning hours from you.



Graduate Attributes

Graduate attributes are the high-level qualities, skills, and understandings that a student should gain as a result of the learning and experiences they engage with, while at university.

In CSIS2624, the graduate attributes that will be incorporated, as well as how this will be assessed, are presented in the table below.

GRADUATE ATTRIBUTE	ASSESSMENT TYPE
Critical thinking	Module assessments; Online quizzes; Assignments; In-class activities
Problem solving	Module assessments; Online quizzes; Assignments; In-class activities
Written communication	Assignments
Ethical reasoning	Module assessments; Online quizzes; In-class activities
Entrepreneurial mind-set	In-class activities; Module assessments.



Module Calander

The module stretches over 14 weeks, during which the following programme will be followed:

WEEK	DATE	DESCRIPTION	WEEK'S ACTIVITIES
1	13 – 17 July Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00	Introduction and Welcome Module Guide & Schedule Module Overview	• Read all welcoming material; • Read Module Guide; • Get textbook; • Prepare Chapter 1 for next week • Complete Class Activity
	Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Class Activity	
2	20 – 24 July Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00	Chapter 1: What is Interaction Design?	
	Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Chapter 2: Process of interaction design?	
3	27 July– 31 July Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00	Chapter 3: Process of interaction design?	• Prepare 1st part of Chapter 1 with aid of learning material; • Prepare 2nd part of Chapter 1 with aid of learning material;
	Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Chapter 4: Cognition and cognitive processes	
4	3 August – 7 August Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00	Chapter 6: Emotional interaction	• Prepare Chapters 2&3 (selections) with aid of learning material; • Quiz 1 (Due date: 10 Aug 2026)
	Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Chapter 7: Interfaces	

5	10 – 14 August	Chapter 7: Interfaces	• Prepare Chapter 4 (selections) with aid of learning material; • Quiz 2 (Due date: 16 Aug 2026)
	Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Chapter 8: Data gathering	
6	17 – 21 August		• Prepare Chapter 6 (selections) with aid of learning material; • Quiz 3 (Due date: 23 Aug 2026) • Practical Assignment Released (Azure Prototyping)
	Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Overview of Axure Chapter 11: Requirements	
7	24 – 28 August	No Class: Study for test 1	• Prepare Chapter 7 (selections) with aid of learning material; • Study for Test 1. • Write Module Test 1
	Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00 Friday 28 August: Test 1	Test 1: Modlec	
8	1 – 4 September	Chapter 11: Requirements	• Prepare Chapter 8 (selections) with aid of learning material; • Study for Test 1. • Quiz 4 (Due date: 6 Sept 2026) • Test 1 discussion
	Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Chapter 12: Prototyping	
9	15 – 19 September	Chapter 14 (Evaluation)	• Prepare Chapters 11 & 12 (selections) with aid of learning material; • Quiz 5 (Due date: 20 Sept 2026) •
	Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Chapter 15 (Evaluation)	
10	22 – 26 September	Chapter 16 (Evaluation)	• Prepare Chapters 14, 15 and 16 (slides).
	Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Screen Design	
11	24 September – 4 October	Holiday Period	

12	5 – 9 October Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	No Class: Study for test 2	• Study for Test 2; • Practical Assignment Due – 11 October 2026 at midnight
	Friday 9 October: Test 2	Semester Test 2 Friday 9 October:	
13	12 – 16 October Tuesday 13 October Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00 Wednesday 14:00 - 15:00	Aegrotat (Sick) Test Complete quiz	• Quiz 6 (Due date: 18 Oct 2026)
14	19 – 23 October Wednesday 08:00 - 09:00	 Test 2 Memo Discussion & Exam Discussion	Predicate Day 23 October
	24 October – 13 Nov	UFS 1st Examination Period - CSIS2624 Exam on campus	Consult UFS exam timetable

FACE-TO-FACE CONTACT SESSIONS

As per the UFS policy, this module will be presented face-to-face during the 2nd semester of 2026. Additional to the CSIS2624 Module Calendar (schedule), I will communicate each week's work to you on a Monday via Blackboard. This will take the form of Blackboard announcements, documents uploaded to Blackboard, as well as emails, WhatsApp messages, and/or webinars.

The two module evaluations (semester tests), aegrotat test (for those who qualify), as well as the final examination, will take place (as either a written or online assessment) face-to-face, on the Bloemfontein campus.

The contact sessions (lectures) for this module are scheduled for the following times and venues:

	Wednesday (Lecture 1)	Wednesday (Lecture 2)	Friday (Non- Compulsory Practical)
Lectures	08:10 – 09:00 Agriculture Building 4 (compulsory)	14:10 – 15:00 Stabilis 1 (compulsory)	
Practical			Periods 8 – 10 14:10 – 17:00 (not compulsory)

It is your own responsibility to ensure that you receive all the information in connection with this module. This information will be made available during face-to-face classes, on Blackboard, via emails, WhatsApp messages, and in the faculty yearbook.

Attendance of all theoretical contact sessions is compulsory. You are required to have an attendance record of **at least 80%**.

Attendance will be recorded in each theoretical class. Please note that only registered students will be allowed to attend the CSIS2624 contact sessions.

Important! If you do not have a class attendance record of at least 80%, you will not be considered for promotion for this module, even if your other marks would normally result in promotion.

CLASS PREPARATION

Before each class, you have to prepare the work that will be covered in class. In order to do this, quizzes have been set up that need to be completed before each class commences. The marks for all these quizzes will contribute towards your semester mark.

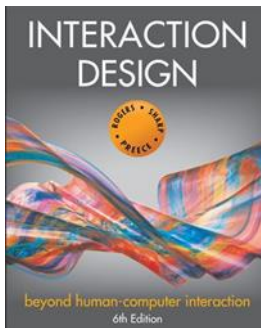
If you do not complete a quiz in time before the due date, you will receive a zero mark for the quiz.

1.1 IMPORTANT! IF YOU HAVE A ZERO MARK ANY OF YOUR QUIZZES, YOU WILL NOT BE CONSIDERED FOR PROMOTION FOR THIS MODULE, EVEN IF YOUR OTHER MARKS WOULD NORMALLY RESULT IN PROMOTION.



Module Text Book

✚ The prescribed textbook in this module is:



Interaction Design – Beyond human-computer interaction

1.2 6TH EDITION

by Helen Sharp, Jennifer Preece and Yvonne Rogers Wiley (2023)

ISBN: 978-1-119-90109-9

The hard copy is available at major book outlets. However, the 6th edition of the textbook can also be obtained in the following ways:

- ✚ The book can also be obtained from previous year students.
- ✚ In addition to the textbook, other study material will be used as part of the teaching and learning in this module. This material and activities will be made available on Blackboard throughout the semester. It is your own responsibility to ensure that you obtain and prepare all study material in time.

The textbook is essential for the successful completion of this module.

Please ensure that you have a copy of the book (paper or electronic), or access to the book, for the first lecture at the start of the semester.

Base on the information provided above, there is no reason at all for you not to have access to the CSIS2624 textbook! ☺



Module Assessment

10.1 ASSESSMENT BREAKDOWN

Your semester mark (predicate) will be calculated as follows:

ASSESSMENT	TYPE (E.G. WRITTEN/ORAL/PRACTICAL)	CONTRIBUTION TO MODULE SEMESTER MARK
Module Test 1	Written on 28 August, on campus	35%
Module Test 2	Written on 9 October, on campus	35%
Aegrotat (Sick) Test	Written on 13 October, on campus	
Assignments and Quizzes	Practical assignment (10%) Quizzes (10%)	20%
Class Attendance	80% or higher = 10 70 – 79% = 7 60 – 69% = 6 50- 59% = 5 Below 50% = 0	10%

The CSIS2624 module mark will be determined based on your marks for two module tests, practical assignments and your quizzes, and attendance. Failure to write/do any of the module assessments while not handing in a valid original or certified doctor certificate (**within 48 hours after the scheduled time of the assessment**), will result in CSIS2624 being indicated as incomplete next to your student number. This implies that you will not be admitted to the final

examination and that you will not be allowed to register for the module again (which could in effect mean the end of your studies at UFS).

CSIS2624 will also be indicated as incomplete next to your student number in any of the following cases:

- If you fail to submit any compulsory assignment or fail to submit it on time.
- If you fail to write at least two module tests (**the aegrotat test may only be written if you qualify, as mentioned above**).

10.2 PROMOTION

The UFS promotion system applies to this CSIS2624 module.

For CSIS2624, if you obtain:

- a semester mark of 70% or higher, AND
- a subminimum of 60% in all the different assessment components, AND
- no zero marks for any of the quizzes, AND
- a class attendance record of at least 80%,

you will be promoted, and you will not have to write the final written examination. If you promote the module, your semester mark will count as the final mark.

Please note that you have to work for a promotion throughout the semester. If you do not comply with the minimum requirements set out above, you will not be considered for promotion, and **it will not be negotiable**.

10.3 ASSIGNMENTS

The following should be noted in terms of assignments:

- All assignments are compulsory.
- No late submissions will be accepted. Your module will be marked incomplete if you do not complete all the assignments on time, and to the satisfaction of the lecturer.
- No co-operation whatsoever between students with assignments and assessment is allowed, except for group assignments (which will be specifically indicated).
- No assistance from any GenAI tool, e.g. ChatGPT, will be allowed, unless an assignment specifically states otherwise. Not complying with this restriction, will come down to plagiarism, and you will be reported to the authorities.
- You may only submit your own work. Students found guilty of any transgression in this regard will be penalised. Action will also be taken against students who help or allow other students to copy their work. A disciplinary procedure is in place to handle these transgressions. Refer to the Departmental Disciplinary Code on Blackboard.

It is your own responsibility to keep **backup copies** of your assignments. Lost or corrupted computer files, network problems, etc., cannot be used as an excuse for late submissions.

Should **loadshedding** be re-instated, you know your schedule beforehand and the due dates for assignments and quizzes are communicated from the start of the semester. Therefore, loadshedding will not be accepted as an excuse for not submitting an assignment or assessment on time.

More detailed assignment information will be made available on Blackboard throughout the semester. It is your responsibility to ensure that you note of all the information and align yourself with the expectations.

10.4 CALCULATION OF THE FINAL MARK

In terms of the Faculty of Natural and Agricultural Sciences calendar, the final mark of this module is calculated as follows:

50% of the module mark PLUS

50% of the examination mark.

As mentioned, in the case of a student who promotes, the semester mark will become the final mark.

10.5 PASSING THE MODULE

A semester mark of 45% is the sub-minimum to be allowed to write the exam. You should obtain a final mark of 50% or more in order to pass this module. In addition, a sub-minimum examination mark of 40% is required.

In order to gain access to a re-assessment, you should have obtained a final mark of at least 45% for the first examination opportunity, and an examination mark of at least 30%.

Should you receive an incomplete or a module mark of less than 30%, you will not be allowed to repeat that module. Students who accumulate less than 64 credits per year will also not be allowed to continue with their studies.

10.6 USING GENAI

Artificial Intelligence (AI) was developed and improved rapidly over the past few years. This meant that technologies, such as ChatGPT, became easily accessible to computer users, including students. Although I support students being exposed to new technology, there is a fine line between using the technology legitimately and using it in such a way as to commit fraud and plagiarism.

In this module, generative AI (GenAI) may NOT be used in assessments and assignments, UNLESS stipulated by the lecturer. If permission was granted to use e.g. ChatGPT, in an assignment, it should be clearly noted in the citations and reference list.

Should you disregard the rules by illegitimately using GenAI, you will be reported to the appropriate authorities in the department and the UFS, which might have serious consequences on your continued studies at the UFS and your future.



11. UPDATING OF MODULE INFORMATION AND RESOURCES

The module schedule and syllabus (study material), either via audio files or via Blackboard announcements/uploads, can be updated or modified at any time by me or the Department of Computer Science & Informatics.

1.3 IT IS YOUR RESPONSIBILITY (AS A STUDENT ENROLLED IN THIS MODULE) TO STAY UP TO DATE WITH THE SCHEDULE AND SYLLABUS.

An announcement of this type can be given during the face-to-face class, via an audio file or communicated on Blackboard. It is recommended that you check Blackboard daily to keep up to date with the latest developments in CSIS2624. Any work covered during the semester can be used for assessment purposes.

Communication with me is preferred via e-mail (BothaBS@ufs.ac.za).